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NEC SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS UK LIMITED

NeoFace Facial Recognition Solution

NEC's NeoFace Facial Recognition is a high performance and scalable face recognition software solution which provides users with a platform to identify a subject in three main categories namely: (i) Image & Video Retrospective Facial Recognition: (ii) Live Facial Recognition and (iii) Operator initiated Face recognition.

Features

- Subject Image Enrolment
- Image-based Retrospective Facial Recognition
- Video-based Retrospective Facial Recognition
- Live Facial Recognition
- Operator Initiated Facial Recognition
- Auditing and reporting tools
- Built in data retention and privacy tools
- Highly configurable solution to accommodate your use cases

Benefits

- Use our world leading NeoFace Facial Recognition algorithm independently
- assessed by the National Physical Laboratory and NIST
- Watchlists can be created, edited or deleted manually or automatically
- Use images or videos to retrospectively identify individuals within them
- Realtime identification based on a watchlist using live facial recognition
- Intuitive GUI, updated over 15 years of feedback from forces
- Identifications on the go using our facial recognition mobile app
- Reduce costs of subject identification from 10 days to minutes
- Easily scale up your solution to maximise the benefits

Pricing

£6.66 a unit

Service documents

- Pricing document

  PDF

- Skills Framework for the Information Age rate card

PDF

- Service definition document

  PDF

- Terms and conditions

  PDF

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Framework

G-Cloud 14

Service ID

2 6 9 7 3 4 6 5 4 3 6 9 5 8 0

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Contact

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Service scope

Software add-on or extension

No

Cloud deployment model

- Public cloud
- Private cloud

Service constraints

Professional services are typically available and provided 9 to 5 (UK time) on weekdays excluding UK bank holidays.
NEC will provide customers with hardware sizing and recommended specifications. Specifications should be used to meet customer's requirements.
Intel or AMD CPUs supported, high CPU and RAM clock frequencies are advised. SSD hard drives are highly recommended.
If using realtime cameras, NVIDIA GPUs may be recommended to improve infrastructure cost. Other GPUs are not supported.
If using Operator Initiated Facial Recognition Package, network connection is required between mobile device and NeoFace servers.

System requirements

- Workstation with a HTML5 Browser (Chrome, Firefox or Microsoft Edge)

- Windows Server 2022
- Microsoft SQL Server 2022
- 1 Gbps for realtime, 10 Mbps for retrospective facial recognition
- Better than 50ms network response time
- Patched with the latest service packs and windows updates
- Must have an English (UK) operating system
- Server dedicated to running NeoFace Facial Recognition solution only

User support

Email or online ticketing support

Email or online ticketing

Support response times

All logged incidents or service requests are acknowledged immediately via NEC's ITSM Support Portal. Timescales will vary in accordance with the priority of the logged ticket, and our targeted response times during contracted support hours are as follows:
Priority 1 (Critical): service unavailable to end-users - 15 working minutes
Priority 2 (Medium): partial loss of an important business function for end-users - 30 working minutes
Priority 3 (Low): low impact on End-User operations where processing can continue - 60 working minutes
Priority 4 (Minor/ guidance and advice): problems affecting 1 or 2 end-users – 1 working day

User can manage status and priority of support tickets

Yes

Online ticketing support accessibility

WCAG 2.1 A

Phone support

Yes

Phone support availability

9 to 5 (UK time), Monday to Friday

Web chat support

No

Onsite support

Yes, at extra cost

Support levels

NEC provides a single level support service, included in the standard charge for the solution.
The details of the support services are:
Available 24x7 excluding planned/emergency maintenance.
Support response available 09:00-17:30 each Business Day.
The solution achieves a minimum of 99.5% availability.
End-users can log tickets online 24x7.
The end-user has the option to assign the priority when logging the ticket, as follows:
Priority 1: Service unavailable to end-users/complete loss of a critical business function/security breach.
Priority 2: Partial loss of a business function at a critical time in the business cycle with medium impact on end-user operations/performance degradation affecting 25% or more of end-users.
Priority 3: Minor problems with low impact on end-user where processing can

continue/performance degradation affecting less than 25% of end-users.
Priority 4: Service Requests/problems affecting 1 or 2 end-users.
NEC uses reasonable commercial endeavours to provide identification and resolution, obviation and/or mitigation of operational bugs/errors reported by the customer in the solution in accordance with these timescales:
Priority 1: 4 working hours.
Priority 2: 8 working hours.
Priority 3: 36 working hours.
Priority 4: 72 working hours.
Client Services Manager manages the ongoing relationship, cloud/support engineers allocated as appropriate to resolve any technical issues.

Support available to third parties

Yes

Onboarding and offboarding

Getting started

The following on-boarding activities will be provided for the Standard Service Package Bronze and Silver Tiers. Any other chosen packages will be evaluated and further on-boarding days will be provided:
Initial delivery of NeoFace Facial Recognition Solution to include, Project Management, installation, solution configuration, scoping study, Bulk image enrolment support.
Train the trainer training is carried out at the customer's premises with accompanying documentation. An NEC trainer will cover in depth technical and admin training. The NEC Trainer will also provide user training, explaining the fundamentals of facial recognition, scenarios where it can and cannot help and the use of the NeoFace Facial Recognition Solution. The trainer will also guide users through the user interface and, in a hands-on session, help users enrol, enhance and search faces alongside generating reports and explore the image comparison tools.
Note all activities are provided on a fixed time basis, any requirement for additional time will be subject to further commercial agreement.

Service documentation

Yes

Documentation formats

PDF

End-of-contract data extraction

Not applicable.

End-of-contract process

Any associated costs with end of contract activities will be based on the NEC SFIA Rate Card.

Using the service

Web browser interface

Yes

Supported browsers

- Microsoft Edge
- Chrome

Application to install

Yes

Compatible operating systems

- Android
- IOS
- Windows

Designed for use on mobile devices

Yes

Differences between the mobile and desktop service

The service can be used by using the NEC Mobile ID Power App for operator initiated facial recognition.

Service interface

Yes

User support accessibility

None or don’t know

Description of service interface

To integrate with the Bronze and Silver NeoFace Facial Recognition solution, REST API, Web Services API and Import Folders interfaces are available.

To integrate with the Gold NeoFace Facial Recognition solution, a Web Services API is available.

CSV and files based bulk loading tools are available for our products to initially populate the databases with millions of customer data records.

Accessibility standards

None or don’t know

Description of accessibility

Not applicable.

Accessibility testing

Not applicable.

API

Yes

What users can and can't do using the API

● Start, stop and update the NEC NeoFace Watch system.
● Work with subjects, photos, and enrolling subjects
● Create, change and manage watchlists, and the subjects in watchlists
● Using matching methods to find matches between probe images and subject photos
● Receive real time notifications when a match hit is detected by the real time processing components

Using the Watch API generally follows one of two workflows:

1. Real-Time Alerting: You enrol and manage subjects and images, manage watchlists, subscribe to events, and receive notifications when face matches occur.

2. Face Matching (Probing): You use the Watch API to perform face matching between images, biometric face parameters, and subject and watchlists.

API documentation

Yes

API documentation formats

- Open API (also known as Swagger)
- PDF

API sandbox or test environment

Yes

Customisation available

Yes

Description of customisation

Different combinations of service packages can be used. Each service also has flexibility to be customised and tailored to specific client needs.

Scaling

Independence of resources

Each client has our solution hosted on their private cloud and other clients' use will not be affected by other's demand.

Should internal users' increase the demands on their system, the software can be scaled both vertically and horizontally as needed.

Analytics

Service usage metrics

No

Resellers

Supplier type

Not a reseller

Staff security

Staff security clearance

Conforms to BS7858:2019

Government security clearance

Up to Security Clearance (SC)

Asset protection

Knowledge of data storage and processing locations

Yes

Data storage and processing locations

United Kingdom

User control over data storage and processing locations

Yes

Datacentre security standards

Supplier-defined controls

Penetration testing frequency

At least once a year

Penetration testing approach

'IT Health Check' performed by a CHECK service provider

Protecting data at rest

Physical access control, complying with another standard

Data sanitisation process

Yes

Data sanitisation type

Explicit overwriting of storage before reallocation

Equipment disposal approach

Complying with a recognised standard, for example CSA CCM v.30, CAS (Sanitisation) or ISO/IEC 27001

Data importing and exporting

Data export approach

CSV and files based bulk loading tools are available for our products to initially populate the databases with millions of subject data records. The APIs can also be used for bulk and ongoing loading and processing of data.

Data can be input and processed through input folders, APIs, and realtime video streams.

Subject data can be exported from the system in batches via the GUI, or in bulk via the API.

Reports can be exported from various parts of the system via the GUI.

Data export formats

- CSV
- Other

Other data export formats

- XLSX
- PDF

Data import formats

- CSV
- Other

Other data import formats

- Images: JPG, BMP, TGA, PGM, PNG, PPM and TIFF
- Videos: MP4, AVI, Axis ASF, MPEG, FLV, MKV, MOV, AVE
- Users can upload images through the GUI, or import folders
- Video Streams including live IP cameras and broadcasts.
- Supported formats: RTSP, MJPEG and codecs such as H.264, H.265.

Data-in-transit protection

Data protection between buyer and supplier networks

- Private network or public sector network
- Other

Other protection between networks

There is no communication or data transfer between the buyer's network and our network as the solution is hosted on the customer's private cloud.

Data protection within supplier network

Other

Other protection within supplier network

As the customer will use their own private cloud, our Network is not used.

Availability and resilience

Guaranteed availability

The service is available 365x24x7, except for planned and emergency maintenance.

Approach to resilience

Available on request.

Outage reporting

The NEC Support Service encapsulates the core disciplines within the Service Operation function defined within the ITIL framework and is certified to the ISO 20000-1: standard (ITMS 590722).

The Major Incident management disciplines are delivered by experienced teams used to working with business critical, high availability services that are essential to the business operations of our customers.

All Support Service team members receive training with respect to the ITIL methodology, with key individuals being ITIL accredited. A number of key individuals are certified to intermediate foundation level.

Identity and authentication

User authentication needed

Yes

User authentication

- Dedicated link (for example VPN)
- Username or password
- Other

Other user authentication

Authentications is handle by the software on the customer's private cloud.

Access restrictions in management interfaces and support channels

Separate networks are used for users, and for support and management purposes. These are logically separated using vlans and firewalls. All management and support staff have access via the management network and end users are excluded.

Access restriction testing frequency

At least once a year

Management access authentication

- Dedicated link (for example VPN)
- Username or password

Audit information for users

Access to user activity audit information

Users have access to real-time audit information

How long user audit data is stored for

User-defined

Access to supplier activity audit information

Users receive audit information on a regular basis

How long supplier audit data is stored for

User-defined

How long system logs are stored for

User-defined

Standards and certifications

ISO/IEC 27001 certification

Yes

Who accredited the ISO/IEC 27001

BSI

ISO/IEC 27001 accreditation date

07/06/2021; valid until June 2024. Certificate IS 598449.

What the ISO/IEC 27001 doesn't cover

N/A our ISO 27001 certification covers all our office location.

ISO 28000:2007 certification

No

CSA STAR certification

No

PCI certification

No

Cyber essentials

Yes

Cyber essentials plus

Yes

Other security certifications

Yes

Any other security certifications

- Cyber Essentials and Cyber Essentials Plus
- Business Continuity Management ISO22301:2019
- Environmental Management ISO14001:2015
- Information Security Management ISO27001:2013
- Service Management ISO20000:2018
- Quality Management ISO9001:2015

Security governance

Named board-level person responsible for service security

Yes

Security governance certified

Yes

Security governance standards

ISO/IEC 27001

Information security policies and processes

The NEC Senior Information Risk Owner (SIRO) operates at board level and has overall responsibility and accountability for all aspect of security governance. The SIRO is supported

by an Information Security Steering Group (ISSG) which is headed by the Security Director and has representatives from all areas within the organisation. The ISSG is responsible for agreeing policies with the SIRO and ensuring they are implemented across the business. An operational Security Working Group (SWG) is responsible for managing any incidents that may occur and in an advisory capacity to provide advice and guidance to the organisation.

Operational security

Configuration and change management standard

Conforms to a recognised standard, for example CSA CCM v3.0 or SSAE-16 / ISAE 3402

Configuration and change management approach

NEC is certified for ISO20000:2018 for Service Management, which covers both our Configuration Management and Change Management processes. This is audited both internally by our Data Protection Officer (DPO) and Head of the Compliance, Risk and Audit team, and externally by the UKAS accredited audit body British Standards Institute, (BSI). NEC follows an ITIL-based approach, and the NEC service desk personnel have undergone the relevant ITIL qualifications for their roles. Our CMDB is updated accordingly throughout the lifetime of the asset, up to and including decommissioning and disposal.

Vulnerability management type

Supplier-defined controls

Vulnerability management approach

NEC has entered into security knowledge sharing partnerships to react to new and increasing threat levels. NEC are members of the NCSC Cyber Security Information Sharing Partnership (CiSP) for early identification and advice on security threats, incidents and solutions. The NEC InfoSec team subscribes to a number of key suppliers and cyber security websites, which send daily alerts on the latest vulnerabilities. NEC are members of the Cyber Network Reporting Service (CNR) that helps the NCSC to rapidly notify organisations that might be affected by malicious software.

Protective monitoring type

Supplier-defined controls

Protective monitoring approach

NEC implements a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) system which provides alerts and reports that enable log sources to be processed in accordance with GPG13. Custom rules can be defined to detect and alert on suspicious behaviour. The InfoSec team reviews the SIEM alerts and reports on a daily basis to check for any anomalous behaviour. The NEC security monitoring policies and practices are aligned with incident management policies and practices. Any significant security issues identified will result in the NEC InfoSec team raising a security incident in the NEC service management system to initiate the detailed analysis process.

Incident management type

Conforms to a recognised standard, for example, CSA CCM v3.0 or ISO/IEC 27035:2011 or SSAE-16 / ISAE 3402

Incident management approach

Incident Management is part of our ISO27001:2022 certified Information Security Management system (ISMS). All incidents are handled within the same process. Users report incidents through the Service Desk, and a Security Incident is then raised on the ISMS. This is reviewed by the Security Team and is managed in accordance with the Security Incident

Management Process. The security incident is kept updated, and once the Security Incident is closed a full report is produced which is used to identify any lessons learnt.

Secure development

Approach to secure software development best practice

Conforms to a recognised standard, but self-assessed

Public sector networks

Connection to public sector networks

No

Social Value

Social Value

Social Value

- Fighting climate change
- Covid-19 recovery
- Tackling economic inequality
- Equal opportunity
- Wellbeing

Fighting climate change

NEC is committed to being Net Zero by 2030.
To support this objective, we targeted a 50% reduction in our 2020 baseline emissions by 2026. We are ahead of target, having already achieved an independently audited reduction of 64% in tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent(tC02e).
We have implemented a multitude of initiatives to support this, including:
-Appointing an Environmental Manager and Environmental Champions to promote our objectives.
-Successfully obtaining certification for and implementing ISO14001:2015 Environmental Management System(EMS).
-Developing a Carbon Reduction Plan, which is published on our website.
-Maintaining an Environmental Aspect and Impact Register (down to site level) through which to capture the elements of our operating practices that could negatively impact the environment.
-Working with government accredited consultants to understand our environmental impact.
-Collaborative activities to influence customers, supply chain partners and employees.
Specific initiatives applicable to our contract delivery approach include:
-Ensuring directly sourced energy is from renewable sources.
Reducing business travel where possible through utilisation of controls and technology such as:
-Video conferencing.
-Electronic sharing of documents.
-Conference call facilities.

-Working from home/flexible working arrangements.
-Approval controls for commercial flights.
-Use of environmentally friendly data centres.
Additionally, our Environmental Policy objectives include:
-Meeting all relevant legal requirements and monitoring our compliance.
-Minimising our environmental impacts for the life cycle (including disposal) of work equipment and other physical assets under our control.
-Demonstrating efficient use of energy, water, and other natural resources
-Maximising opportunities to minimise our waste by reusing or recycling waste, where practical.
-Ensuring our supply chain are aware of our environmental policy and our commitment to ensuring its effective implementation.
Increasing environmental awareness and commitment amongst employees through training and briefings.
We'll continue to identify opportunities to improve our environmental performance through clear objectives, plans and targets.

Covid-19 recovery

During the COVID-19 global health crisis, NEC supported its workforce, customers and the local communities they serve, to adapt to the challenges the pandemic posed. As a provider of software and services to the public sector, this included the rapid development and deployment of software solutions to enable the efficient and effective delivery of new government schemes and changes in legislation introduced as a direct response to the pandemic. Examples include provision of software to assist with Test and Trace Support Payments and new hospitality sector licensing requirements.
Initiatives we implemented that support the policy outcomes include:
• Increasing our pre-pandemic workforce numbers through recruitment of an additional 250 UK based roles, many of whom were unemployed following redundancy from other sectors such as hospitality.
• Re-training and redeploying temporarily displaced colleagues rather than imposing redundancies or taking advantage of the furlough scheme.
• Investing over £400,000 in training and apprenticeships.
• Working collaboratively with customers to introduce new ways of working.
• Delivering community based social value through donations in kind to voluntary sector organisations impacted by the pandemic.
As part of our response to the pandemic we invested in and introduced several initiatives and workplace adaptations to protect employee health and safety, including:
• Introducing wider use of remote and flexible working, including making additional allowances for those caring for young children.
• Enhancing office safety, including installing sanitising stations, hygiene screens and digital thermometers.
• Increasing the frequency of colleague communications, with a focus on provision of mental health support and reducing the risks of isolation/loneliness.
• Providing all employees with free access to additional specialist resources, including 24x7 counselling and mental health services.

Tackling economic inequality

We recognise the expertise, innovation and value that can be gained from having a diverse supply chain and providing all suppliers with a fair and equal opportunity to become suppliers to us and our customers. We operate openly and transparently to enable this collaborating with third-party suppliers including large enterprises, sub-contractors, SMEs, VCSEs, mutuals and social enterprise organisations.
Additionally, we are committed to nurturing talent and creating a sustainable learning and development culture that equips our workforce with the appropriate skills, knowledge and processes so that the company continues to deliver innovative, industry leading solutions.
Processes and practices we have adopted to tackle economic inequality include:
• Using outcome-based specifications and co-design methods to encourage suppliers, communities, users and third sector organisations to collaborate and propose solutions based upon end user requirements, rather than being prescriptive.
• Advertising supply chain opportunities openly and always operating transparently.
• Including modules covering anti-bribery and corruption, whistleblowing, equality and diversity in our all-colleague compulsory Annual Compliance Training.
• Having policies and operating practices that support effective supply chain relationships through fair selection and responsible management. For example, only flowing down appropriate contract terms.
• Paying at least 95% of all invoices within agreed terms and agreeing to reduced payment terms for SMEs and subcontractors.
• Never deducting sums from payments as a charge for remaining on our supplier list.
• Investing in new jobs and training opportunities through an active Apprenticeship scheme. We recruited 18 apprentices in 2023.
• Creating opportunities for career progression and investing in reward and recognition initiatives that support employee retention.
• Following the foundational principles of the Good Work Plan in respect of employee satisfaction, fair pay, well-being and safety, career progression, voice, and autonomy.
• Having appropriate controls in place to mitigate cyber security risks.

Equal opportunity

We want to be an employer of choice for people of all backgrounds and we are committed to ensuring workers either directly employed or employed within our supply chains are treated fairly, humanely, and equitably. We will not discriminate on grounds of gender, marital status, race, ethnic origin, colour, nationality, national origin, disability, sexual orientation, religion, age or any other characteristic.
To encourage a diverse and varied workforce our approach to equal opportunity includes:
-Inclusive and accessible recruitment practices, including supporting candidates and employees with disabilities through provision of supportive technology and/or changes to working practices.
-Collecting, analysing and senior reporting of equality and diversity data obtained during recruitment activities.
-Making appointments on the grounds of selecting the most suitable candidate for the post.
-Ensuring job adverts reach a diverse audience, including utilising job sites which encourage interest from disadvantaged and Minority Ethnic groups.
-Having diverse interview panels and anonymising applications.
-Using gender-neutral role definitions.
-Ensuring policies and employee communications promote respect and equality for all.

Other activities to support equal opportunity within the workforce include:
-Tackling the gender pay gap, through annual audits. Women now comprise 50% of our leadership team, including our Chief Executive.
-Compliance with the Modern Slavery Act 2015 and the nine core principles of the Ethical Trading Initiative Base Code.
-Ensuring effective supply chain controls are in place to mitigate and manage the risks of exploitation.
-Provision of appropriate channels for colleagues to have an effective voice, such as our Employee Steering Group.
-Investment in workforce development and training, including an active Apprenticeship programme.
-No use of zero hours contracts or fire and rehire practices.
-Being a Real Living Wage Employer.
-Flexible working practices.
-Transparent and structured promotion, pay and reward processes.
-Senior level sponsorship at board level to support and promote equal opportunity.

Wellbeing

Our approach to supporting good health and wellbeing includes providing our workforce with:
• Access to helpful health and wellbeing resources through our dedicated intranet Wellness Hub.
• A LinkedIn Learning Platform that includes a section dedicated to health and wellbeing, including advice for managers on opening up dialogue about mental health and emotional safety.
• Free and confidential access to specialist resources 24x7, including counselling and mental health services through our Employee Assistance Programme.
• Private healthcare cover including a Doctor at Hand service for fast and convenient access to advice, assistance and medical treatment, anytime and anywhere.
• Maintaining compliance with the six standards of the Mental Health at Work commitment.
• Accommodating workplace adjustments, such as supportive technology for those with a disability or health condition.
• Encouraging good physical health by providing discounted corporate gym membership at over 3,300 participating gyms through our employee GymFlex scheme.
• Access to a cycle to work scheme through salary sacrifice.
Employee Communications
We incorporate national health and wellbeing campaigns within our yearly communications calendar to raise employee awareness and signpost to useful support pathways. Our 2024 calendar will include the following nationally recognised campaigns:
• Mental Health Awareness week.
• World Menopause Day.
• National Eye Health week.
• World Diabetes Day.
• Stress Awareness Month.
• Suicide Prevention Day.
• Men's Health week.
We have Mental Health First Aiders who are trained to spot the signs of mental ill health and can provide early support for colleagues who may be developing a mental health issue.

Policies

Support for employee health and wellbeing is underpinned by a policy framework including:

• Health and Safety Policy
• Alcohol, Drugs & Solvent Abuse Policy
• Menopause Policy
• Absence Policy
• Flexible Working Policy
• Gender Reassignment Policy.

Pricing

Price

£6.66 a unit

Discount for educational organisations

No

Free trial available

No

Service documents

- Pricing document

  PDF

- Skills Framework for the Information Age rate card

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- Service definition document

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